

Injured Hawk Is 'Better'

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Record Reporter

A Red Tailed Hawk that was taken to the Carolina Raptor Center in Charlotte has been moved to a large flight cage and has an appointment with an eye doctor in two weeks, said Pat Marcum, director of the Raptor Center.

"He's doing better," Marcum said. "When we first got him, it looked like he might be blind from the concussion. It was really bad."

The bird was found on the morning of Jan. 9 by an unidentified man on N.C. 742. The hawk had apparently been hit by a car.

The man took the hawk to Wadesboro Police station and the Raptor Center was called. The center arranged for one of their volunteers to meet Anson County Sheriff's deputies at the Union County line and then took the bird to Charlotte.

There had been some concern that the hawk had suffered internal injuries, because he was wheezing. Marcum said the breathing problems may have been a cold that has cleared up.

The biggest area of concern now is the hawk's vision. When he was first brought in, the hawk had blood in one of its eyes.

Marcum said the hawk's vision isn't as good as they would have hoped it would be and that the bird cannot be released unless its vision is perfect, because it would have a difficult time finding food.

The bird will be checked by a veterinary eye specialist, Dr. Jesse Eichenbaum, to see if its vision is getting better.

"He is getting better," Marcum said. "He's in a flight cage. He's a lot better than he

Hawk

Continued From Page 1B

was when we got him."

Marcum said the Raptor Center has three types of cages. The first type is the intensive care cage, which is used after the birds come into the center.

When the birds are well enough, they are moved to an intermediate flight cage, which is 16 feet long, and then to a large flight cage, which is 50

feet long. This gives the birds a chance to exercise, Marcum said.

"This is finally where we tell if they can fly well enough to survive," Marcum said.

The Raptor Center is a facility in Charlotte that rehabilitates injured birds of prey. In 1990, the center cared for 470 birds and has received 100 injured birds in 1991.